

Separate evaluation from certainty

Chess Math

THE IDEA

An engine score estimates a position under its search and model; it is not a proof of your practical winning chances. A numerical edge can depend on difficult moves. Mate announcements and exact tablebase results have different meanings from an ordinary score.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A position evaluated at +1 may require several precise defenses to retain the advantage. A simpler position with a smaller score may be easier for you to handle, but simplicity does not change objective tactics.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why should you not interpret +2 as 'two guaranteed extra pawns'?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The score summarizes many factors and is expressed on a pawn-like scale. It may reflect attack, activity, or long-term pressure instead of an actual material surplus.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use numerical evaluations to ask questions, then inspect the line.